Diagramatix — Quick Reminder Sheet 4

Value Chain Diagrams

A Value Chain diagram is the executive, top-of-the-house view of an organisation's processes: a left-to-right sequence of the major end-to-end processes that together create value for a customer. It is deliberately simple — a handful of big chevrons rather than detailed flow — and acts as the map from which you drill down into BPMN, flowcharts, or sub-chains. Use it for process architecture, landscape overviews, and giving stakeholders a single page that says "this is what we do, in order".

ELEMENTS

Process (chevron) — A broad arrow-shaped block representing one major process or capability in the chain. Chevrons sit shoulder-to-shoulder so the eye reads them as a left-to-right flow of value. Label each with a verb-noun process name (e.g. "Acquire Customer", "Fulfil Order").

Collapsed Process (linked chevron) — A chevron that stands in for a whole sub-diagram: click it to drill down into the linked detail (another value chain, a BPMN model, or a flowchart). Use it to keep the top level clean while still letting readers navigate into the detail beneath each process.

Value Chain (container) — A grouping frame that holds a set of related chevrons under one banner, letting you show primary processes and supporting processes as distinct bands, or nest a chain within a larger landscape.

HOW TO USE IT

- Read left-to-right: earlier chevrons feed later ones. Keep the count small (typically 5–9) so it stays a *summary*, not a process model.
- Reserve the boxes for **primary** value-creating processes; put enabling/supporting processes in a separate band or their own chain.
- Link each chevron to its detail so the value chain doubles as a navigation index across your whole process library.

Tip: Collapsed chevrons make the Value Chain the natural landing page in the Process Portal — one click takes a reader from the big picture into the exact procedure they need.